OEKO-TEX® Association
General Manager Meeting

26th – 27th October 2023, Budapest

Minutes

Persons present (GMs and representatives in alphabetical order):

On-site: Vicente Blanes (AITEX), Inga Bleyer (OEKO-TEX® Zurich), Dr Grazia Cerini (CENTROCOT), Braz Costa (CITEVE), Stephen Donnelly (SHIRLEY), Dr Stefan Droste (HOHENSTEIN), Dr Radoslaw Dziuba (IW), Carolin Franitza (OEKO-TEX® Zurich), Dr Jean-Pierre Haug (OEKO-TEX and TESTEX), Dr Heike Illing-Günther (STFI), Pavol Kopecny (VUTCH), Jan Laperre (CENTEXBEL), Robert Löcker (OETI), Prof Dr Stefan Mecheels (HOHENSTEIN), Lene Jul Östblom (RISE), Dr Livia Kokas Palicska (INNOVATEXT), Clarisse Reille (IFTH), Johnny Rodam (DTI), Rainer Roten (TESTEX), Athanasios Stamou (Mirtec), Prof Dr Haiko Schulz (FILK), Toshiaki Yamazaki (NISSENKEN)

Excused: Matz Bachmann (TESTEX), Prof Dr Jochen Gutmann (DTNW)

Virtual participants: OEKO-TEX® Team, Zurich
Speakers: Ms Birgitte Langer (SPOOR), Mr Joshua Wickerham (ISEAL), Ms Lisa Schwarz Bour (RISE), Oliver Maukner (Hidetrail), Jose Gasque (Stardust)

Preparation of minutes: OEKO-TEX® Team Zurich

Welcome

Dr. Jean-Pierre Haug, interim CEO of the OEKO-TEX® Association and chairperson of the General Manager Meeting, officially welcomes all people present and gives a note of thanks to Innovatext for organizing the 2023 meeting. He thanked all members of the OEKO-TEX® Association for the good cooperation and fruitful discussions of the past year.

The meeting was opened, 26th October 9:00am.

1. Finances

The numbers and results of the OEKO-TEX Service GmbH were presented. All results were verified by independent accountants. It was noted that IT incurs excessive costs two years in a row. Additionally, maintaining the old init IT system with the current initialization is financially burdensome.

Rainer Roten explains the current financial situation in detail. Company created massive overspending for IT-projects in the last two fiscal years getting us into financial distress by the end of last fiscal year ending June 30th, 2023. In course of those occurrences, OEKO-TEX® released 1.9 Mio. CHF of provisions over the last two years and activated 0.43 Mio. CHF in IT-project costs in order to abide by the beneficial tax ruling with the canton of Zurich in Switzerland. Mentioned tax ruling works as follows: 5% of direct cost items need to be shown as taxable profit. This is a very beneficial ruling that comes with high flexibility. However, it is to be applied symmetrically, which means the following for us: In case we have excess profitability, we reimburse some of the licenses paid by the franchisees in relation to their overall yearly contribution. This was last the case in fiscal year 2020/2021. On contrast, if we do not reach the 5% profits related to direct costs, then we are to either release reserves as we have done the last two fiscal years or capitalize spendings ("create" an asset and hereby reducing costs and increasing profits) as this was the case in recent fiscal year 2022/2023. If that still does not suffice to reach the 5% profit level then in a last resort proceeding and worst case scenario, we oblige franchisee institutes to make additional contributions.

As an immediate measure, Hohenstein and TESTEX granted a loan of 1 Mio. CHF to OEKO-TEX® in total in order to stabilize the financial situation. Furthermore, we are implementing actions to get the company back on track in order to do the utmost to prevent described worst case scenario from happening.

Please see the financial presentation for more details.

2. Organisational Changes

Georg Dieners and Dr. Dominik Kinschel have departed from the company due to the IT department's challenges. As of July 2023, all IT decisions are being overseen by Peter Kuhn, who holds the position of CIO at Hohenstein, and he is collaborating with Mr. Vittek from TESTEX. Additionally, the process of searching for a new General Manager for the OEKO-TEX® Association has commenced, and the job profile will soon be disseminated to the institutes.

3. Minutes: General Manager Meeting 2022

No comments were made concerning the minutes of last year´s General Manager Meeting in Rome (20th – 21st October 2022) and therefore they are accepted as being sent out.

4. Portfolio Statistics

The last business year was a successful year for OEKO-TEX®. MADE IN GREEN grew strongest by 52% which is a great step for OEKO-TEX®. Further details can be found in the presentation.

5. Reports of the Institutes

(Alphabetical order)

5.1 AITEX

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2022 to 06/2023	Audits from 07/2022 to 06/2023
STANDARD 100	2249 (+17%)	734
LEATHER STANDARD	4	1
STeP (active cert.)	106	106
MADE IN GREEN	945 (number of labels) / 46 label owners	-
ECO PASSPORT	117	26

General information:

- New division was created for cosmetics
- Aitex is currently in the process of moving into the new facility (30,000 m^2)

Distribution of Annex and product classes

- No significant changes - Please see the presentation for details

PR activities are presented (LinkedIn, seminars, social media, etc.)

- Please see the presentation

5.2 Centexbel

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2022 to 06/2023	Audits from 07/2022 to 06/2023
STANDARD 100	1000 / 1050 (in 2023)	289 / 77 open
LEATHER STANDARD	5	-
STeP (active cert.)	29 (11 in progress)	-
MADE IN GREEN	72	-
ECO PASSPORT	28	-

Circular Economy:
Centexbel is involved in research, recycling multi-layered materials and removing harmful substances from textiles & plastics.
REACH4TEXTILES September 21 - August 23

- Project to train EU market surveillance agencies for detecting non-compliant REACH textiles entering Europe.
- Risk-based sampling strategies
- First results were presented
- The final results will be available soon, but first insights can be found in the presentation.

Suggestions, questions, comments:
Jean-Pierre Haug: How could the recycling challenge enter the OEKO-TEX® environment.
Centexbel , JL: Can we compete with GRS as a very strong competitor. Legal expertise of each market is needed. There is a lot to consider to set up standards and testing for recycling.

5.3 CENTROCOT

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2022 to 06/2023	Audits from 07/2022 to 06/2023
STANDARD 100	1376 (155 recyceld materials)	134
LEATHER STANDARD	13	4
STeP (active cert.)	39 (+21)	17
MADE IN GREEN	112 (number of labels)	-
ECO PASSPORT	75	12

General information:

- Best practice from MultiLab was shared: Please see the presentation for details
- React Project: remove harmful substance coming from the environment
  How can this project work with a STANDARD 100 recycled materials.
  New certification: OEKO-TEX® Eco design certification is requested
- Challenge: How to manage the risk analysis to obtain an OEKO-TEX® STANDARD 100 certification for recycled.
  Guidebook has recommendation about post-consumer fast.
  Jean-Pierre Haug asks that Centrocot technical staff should contact the STANDARD 100 working group
- Centrocot has challenges to deliver the audits due to lack of staff
- STeP was introduced by the Italian government
- MADE IN GREEN is decreasing due to the lack of understanding. Need support of OEKO-TEX® Marketing to explain better.

Marketing activities:

- Social Media: LinkedIn is very good medium with high quality followers. Instagram and Facebook is work in progress.

Italian Fashion Market:

- Italian textile fashion industry is presenting a strong part of the EU turnover and grew by 3,8%.

5.4 Citeve

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	≈1400	≈ 110
LEATHER STANDARD	1	-
STeP (active cert.)	31 / 3 new / 6 in process	-
MADE IN GREEN	19 / 3 label owner	-
ECO PASSPORT	8	-

General information:

- Citeve is heavily investing into digitalisation

Marketing:

- Attending various fairs
- Social Media

Challenges

- More user-friendly IT technology, OEKO-TEX® needs to simplify the working progress within the system

Opportunities:

- MADE IN GREEN – clear demand for an traceability tool in the market
- EU Strategy for sustainable and circular textile
- Recovering with the number of audits after Covid 19

Suggestions, questions, comments:

- Monitoring and engagement from OEKO-TEX® regarding the development of DDP (digital product passport) is needed.

5.5 DTI

DANISH TECHNOLOGICAL INSTITUTE

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	161 (+6.9)	25 (behind schedule)
LEATHER STANDARD	-	-
STeP (active cert.)	8 (2 new and 4 in pipeline)	-
MADE IN GREEN	239 (50 label owners) (+400%)	-
ECO PASSPORT	-	-
DETOX TO ZERO	1	-

General information:

- Challenge: There is a requirement for additional manpower, but it is proving to be a challenge to locate suitably qualified personnel.
- A price for transaction certificate is missing.

Hohenstein, SD: We as Hohenstein takes it up and will come back to the group with a suggestion

- MADE IN GREEN very high interests but also increasing workload.
- How to deal with the cost according to MADE IN GREEN? Any idea coming from the OEKO-TEX® secretariat?
- Very high interest in sustainability & social responsibility in the market
- Marketing activities: 3 seminars, involvement in public procurement, sustainability projects.
- 1 additional consultant for OEKO-TEX®

5.6 Filk

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2022 to 06/2023	Audits from 07/2022 to 06/2023
STANDARD 100	2	-
LEATHER STANDARD	27	-
STeP (active cert.)	4(2 in progress)	-
MADE IN GREEN	2	-
ECO PASSPORT	0	-
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

- Stronger influence of EU regulation on the leather sector (details in the presentation)
- PFAS is not a huge problem in the leather industry
- Training and education in leathers is cost intensive and a challenge / less educated staff
- Presentation of the results of the survey done by ILM – please see the presentation for details
- Strong competition with LWG but increasing influence of OEKO-TEX® in the leather sector
- Several marketing activities (COTANCE stakeholder engagement)
  Discussion with luxury brands and groups about STeP
- Great success: Deutsche Bahn included LEATHER STANDARD in their specifications
- More activities to convince brands to use OEKO-TEX® system. Stakeholder management support from OEKO-TEX® is highly appreciated and needed.

Suggestions, questions, comments:

Filk, HS: Traceability in leather sector: as general decision from OEKO-TEX® is needed!

5.7 HOHENSTEIN

HOHENSTEIN

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2022 to 06/2023	Audits from 07/2022 to 06/2023
STANDARD 100	12,526 (+12%)	4897
LEATHER STANDARD		1
STeP (active cert.)	568 (25%)	-
MADE IN GREEN	6773 (label owners 247 (+12))	-
ECO PASSPORT	524 (+22%)	-

General information:

- Challenge to find and hire of textile professionals / Expansion of team (balance sales and technical knowhow)
- Shrinking buyer market in Germany (inflation, transformation of sourcing, ..)
- Hohenstein still need to pick up on audits after Covid 19

ECO PASSPORT

- ECO PASSPORT is having a momentum in the market. The demand is growing

Market Needs:

OEKO-TEX® governance is a black box for customers. We need to communicate much more on our effort and talk about what we invest in product control. Hohenstein sees a big opportunity here to differentiate from competitors. Communication needs to be improved!

ORGANIC COTTON / Recycling

- GOTS is our main competitor
- Our certificates demand is growing
- How do we grow the demand, have the customer centric approach
- Traceability is key (mass balance tracing) – OEKO-TEX® needs to invest in IT, if the OEKO-TEX® ORGANIC COTTON certification is to remain / grow in the market

What type of OEKO-TEX® do we want to be? Integrity, Reliability, Comparability

But:

- Competition of institutes leads to costumer confusion and may damage quality and reputation.
- Increase of retest fails in RSL programs.

Request from Hohenstein, SD: A robust communication system among all institutes needs to be established, particularly when dealing with unreliable suppliers.
OEKO-TEX® will return with a proposal for a solution on how to establish an effective communication system for improved coordination among institute

5.8 IFTH

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2022 to 06/2023	Audits from 07/2022 to 06/2023
STANDARD 100	Appr. 530	109 (for 2023)
LEATHER STANDARD		-
STeP (active cert.)	4 (2 in process)	-
MADE IN GREEN	355 labels (9 label owners)	-
ECO PASSPORT	1 (1 in progress) Development is planned in 2024	-

General information:

- Investing first time in a marketing department (two new people are responsible for OEKO-TEX®)
- New board of director (certification manager Ms. Laurence Petitpierre)
- Joint forces between IFTH and DEFI was created by law. Please see the resulting projects in the presentation
- A lot of regulations and laws regarding textile sustainability in France make it difficult and complex for brands at the moment
- Opportunity: French Eco-Modulation principle – MADE IN GREEN is recognized in the system

Increasing effort with OEKO-TEX®

- Offering OEKO-TEX® packages to brands
- Many communication and marketing activities (PV, webinars, newsletter)
- Social media impacts
- Plan to expand business

5.9 INNOVATEXT

INNOVATEXT®

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2022 to 06/2023	Audits from 07/2022 to 06/2023
STANDARD 100	92	17 (+6 for HTTI)
LEATHER STANDARD		-
STeP (active cert.)	15	10 (+6 for HTTI)
MADE IN GREEN	23 (1 label owner)	-
ECO PASSPORT		-

General information:

- The inflation is high in Hungary as well (food prices increase by 40%)
- 83 OEKO-TEX® customers
- 1 new auditor
- All Audits are done on-site
- Marketing: workshops, textile magazines, trade fairs, TV, webinars, You Tube , leaflets
- Social media: LinkedIn, Facebook

Challenges:

- What implications has the EU Textile Strategy for OEKO-TEX® certification?
- How to improve LEATHER STANDARD ?

Suggestions, questions, comments:

- none

5.10 IW

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2022 to 06/2023	Audits from 07/2022 to 06/2023
STANDARD 100	218 in 2022 (so far in 2023 171)	-
LEATHER STANDARD	-	-
STeP (active cert.)	7 (1 new certificate)	-
MADE IN GREEN	80 labels (2 label owners)	-
ECO PASSPORT	-	-

General information:

- Different promotion via different channels, TV, radio, fair, conferences
- High activity in Social Media

Suggestions, questions, comments:

- none

5.11 Mirtec

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	98 in 2022	-
LEATHER STANDARD		-
STeP (active cert.)	2	-
MADE IN GREEN		-
ECO PASSPORT		-

General information:

- On-Site Visits are delayed still due to Covid
- Marketing efforts: trade fairs, coals media, public procurement

Suggestions, questions, comments:

- none

5.12 Nissenken

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	462 (-1%)	52
LEATHER STANDARD	Inquiries about leather belts and shoes	-
STeP (active cert.)	1 (first certificate in Apri)	-
MADE IN GREEN	71	-
ECO PASSPORT	38 (+15%)	-
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

- Japanese yen is 20% cheaper to dollar, so request for textile industry is increasing
- A webinar with ZDCH increased the request for ECO PASPORT
- LEATHER STANDARD: the first application was accepted in Sept. 23. The certificate will be issued in November.
- Integration of the Japanese Website to the OEKO-TEX® CMS

Suggestions, questions, comments:

- none

5.13 Oeti

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2022 to 06/2023	Audits from 07/2022 to 06/2023
STANDARD 100	1169 (+181)	-
LEATHER STANDARD	10	-
STeP (active cert.)	75 (+25%)	-
MADE IN GREEN	278 labels (+38%)	-
ECO PASSPORT	32 (+12%)	-

General information and challenges:

- Because of the intricate IT system of MADE IN GREEN, Oeti did not prioritize its promotion. An IT solution is needed.
- The recycling application lacks sufficient clarity, and there is a need for improved communication avenues regarding recycling. This has already been stated last year without any progress or information.
- There is internal competition between ORGANIC COTTON and STANDARD 100 GMO that is needed to be solved in the nearby future.
- ECO PASSPORT guidance is needed from the OEKO-TEX® secretariat for the pricing system. Offers well below the package pricing system are offered.
  OEKO-TEX® will set up an internal communication / complaint system to monitor and solve these competition cases with large impact to the quality of our certifications within the association.
- OKEO-TEX® must harmonize the requirements for On Site Visit between the institute – same standards are needed. No negotiation from customer should be possible.
- Impact calculator extension to other parts is requested by the market

Suggestions, questions, comments:
A general discussion regarding pricing for testing offers was initiated:

Centrocot GC: Some institute give a detailed offer (with all tests) some institutes just give a general offer for testing? Is there a rule how to offer from OEKO-TEX®?
Hohenstein SD: Discounts are seen by testing offers in the market.
Oeti RL: Therefore we have a list with recommended prices and we need to respect it.
Hohenstein SD: The quality of our certification should always be our first goal – not testing only half of the parameters.
DTI JR: The application requires different testing.
Shirley SD: Protect our margin – and speak to each other.
Hohenstein SD: Be aware of competition law and if you want to establish a system we need to execute the consequences. We have to talk about quality not about prices.
OEKO-TEX®, JPH: The interim management will discuss internally and come back to the General Managers with a suggestion.

Suggestion:
OETI, RL: Recommended testing prices to be increased by at least 10% to reflect the inflation in Europe

Suggestion: The decision making process was postponed to the next day. Please see paragraph 7 of the minutes for the decision.

5.14 RISE

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	≈ 140 for 2023 (no big change in comparison to last year) low interest in Annex 6	3
LEATHER STANDARD	1	-
STeP (active cert.)	1 in certification process	-
MADE IN GREEN	-	-
ECO PASSPORT	?	-

General information:

- Reorganization during the last year with a heavy focus on the textile value chain.
- RISE can analyse with more than 10 chemical laboratories OEKO-TEX® tasks
- Building up OEKO-TEX® forces and staff to grow
- PFAS and OEKO-TEX® rules with customers has been a challenge and caused discussions

Marketing Activities:

- seminars and webinars are planned and generate interest

Suggestions, questions, comments:

5.15 Shirley

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2022 to 06/2023	Audits from 07/2022 to 06/2023
STANDARD 100	Ca. 1550 (annex 6 is 50%)	-
LEATHER STANDARD		-
STeP (active cert.)	42 (little new certificates)	-
MADE IN GREEN	3700 labels (374 MIG customers,)	-
ECO PASSPORT	≈ 28 (no key driver)	-

General information:

- Shirely increased prices in 2023 by 10% and had no push back from customers.
- Still catching up on site visits post covid 19
- Lead auditor. Can there be more than 1 lead auditor? Additional senior auditor are having additional rights.
  JPH agreed that multiple auditors with the additional qualifications (Senior auditor with additional rights) can be appointed, but there must be a single point of contact for the OEKO-TEX® team.
- MADE IN GREEN IT system needs urgently to improved due to workload at institute and customer level
- Christy is interested in RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS
- Shirley would be interested to participate in the Working Group RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS

Success Story:

- Wimbledon towels (MADE IN GREEN labelled) a great Marketing opportunity were implemented

Challenges:

- RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS: Brands in the UK are interested in ESG and are engaged with B Corp
- Audits in China can only be carried out by approved CNCA auditors.
  Testex, RR: No Auditors trained in the UK are allowed to carry out audits in China. This could harm the OEKO-TEX® reputation in China and could lead to major challenges in China market.
  Please reach out to the association for collaboration.

5.16 STFI:

SÄCHSISCHES TEXTIL FORSCHUNGS INSTITUT e.V.

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2022to 06/2023	Audits from 07/2022 to 06/2023
STANDARD 100	442 in 2022 (of which are 24 first certifications)	39

General Information:

- New building (Center of textile sustainability) and a new colleague joint for circular economy
- Challenges for find staff with an expertise in the textile industry

Competences of STFI:

- **Please see the presentation**

5.17 TESTEX

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2022 to 06/2023	Audits from 07/2022 to 06/2023
STANDARD 100	7996 (+967 certificates)	-
LEATHER STANDARD	10	-
STeP (active cert.)	95 (+32% increase compared to last year)	-
MADE IN GREEN	57 (Number of labelowner)	-
ECO PASSPORT	366	-

General information:

- Nearly up to date with the OTC site-visit after covid 19
- Marketing: fairs, social media, webinars, stakeholder management

Challenges:

- Offering a user friendly IT system is mandatory for future success
- Geopolitical situation fuels uncertainty for the business
- High inflation

Opportunities:

- Open the impact calculator up for non-STeP customers – Hohenstein (SD) agrees on this opportunities
- Traceability needs an IT solution – the new IT organisational set up enables opportunities

5.18 Vutch

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2022 to 06/2023	Audits from 07/2022 to 06/2023
STANDARD 100	22	3
LEATHER STANDARD	-	-
STeP (active cert.)	-	-
MADE IN GREEN	-	-
ECO PASSPORT	-	-

General information:

Challenges:

- Vutch went through an internal re-organization and transformation process including a renaming
- Two new person on the OEKO-TEX® team
- Goal: Increase On Site Visits for 2024
- Price negotiation with customers – but quality is not allowed to be hampered.

Marketing

- Webinars, radio and media

Discussion:
Vutch, PK: How can we follow up the usage of base certificate by brands throughout the supply chain.
Hohenstein, SD: We should learn how GRS is doing it.

6. Why is collaboration important? ISEAL-Input

6.1 General Input

Main information: See presentation slide 3 - 14
About ISEAL: 3 –7
Collaborations: 8 – 11
Policies and regulations: 12 -14

6.2 Q&A

OEKO-TEX, JPH: Does the ISEAL partnership support the OEKO-TEX® Association getting ready for potential impacts of the EU Green Deal?

- ISEAL, JW: Guidance on the impact claims that can be made through a certification, relevance of 3rd party verification, accreditation, ensure the credibility of the assurance system

HHTI, SM: Is the EU Green Claim Directive a danger for OEKO-TEX® as a standard organisation?

- ISEAL, JW: ISEAL follows the developments, looks for good practices, leads an exchange with the members.

HHTI, SD: Interoperability – recognize each other, is in conflict with interests? Why of such an importance for that?

- ISEAL, JW: There is an external pressure from governments.
- HHTI, SD: OEKO-TEX® has trust issues.
- ISEAL, JW: Securing the assurance is a good practice to ensure trust.

HTTI, SD: How do you perceive the OEKO-TEX® system?

- ISEAL, JW: OEKO-TEX® is very technical. Meets many credibility requirements. Hopes to develop towards the code complaint membership. The assurance system is strong.

HTTI, SD: Is there a process how we can learn?

- ISEAL, JW: Theory of change could be improved, movement towards focus on impact, monitoring and evaluation process.

7. Discussion on price increase for recommended prices

Decision making procedure

Every member of the OEKO-TEX® Association is asked whether the institute agrees on a price increase or not. If 2/3 of the members agree on a price increase, the recommended price increase will be conducted. The members are asked on the desired percentage increase. The average of all percentages will be taken to define the price increase. The shareholders have a voting right.

Voting results

Institute	Increase / Decrease	If increase, percentage of increase
Aitex	Increase	3
Centexbel	Increase	10
Centrocot	Increase	3
Citeve	Increase	5
DTI	Increase	5
FILK	Increase	7
Hohenstein	Increase	6
IFTH	Increase	3
Innovatext	Increase	3
Nissenken	Increase	3
OETI	Increase	10
RISE	Increase	7
Shirley	Increase	10
STFI	No voting right	/
Testex	Increase	8
VUTCH	Increase	10

Decision: The OEKO-TEX® association will increase the recommended prices by 6% starting from January 2024. The fees to the OEKO-TEX® secretariat will grow equally.

8. OEKO-TEX® Vision

Main information: see presentation slide 117 - 127

HTTI, SD: The OEKO-TEX® Association needs alignment on the business orientation, which requires resources to support the OEKO-TEX® Secretariat on that work. Hohenstein and Testex will have a look into the strategy together with the OEKO-TEX® secretariat and will prepare a call to action with strategic projects for the next General Manager meeting. As decisions are currently made more random, the strategy offers great opportunities.

HTTI, SD: Do the institutes identify with the strategy?

IFTH, CR: What are our competitors in traceability? IFTH visited Lectra. They offer a powerful traceability tool. How can we compete with them? It would require a big investment. It would be helpful to have a map on competitors. Data structuring is very important for the brands.

- HTTI, SD: Agree, start within our digitalization approach should be the connection of own data and provision in a useful form to our customers. We need to define the endpoints we are discussing on, requiring a definition of 3 to 4 strategic projects.
- TESTEX, JH: Weed need to work on the digital background to generate a solid basis that is open for future developments.

CENTROCOT, GC: Did the OEKO-TEX® Secretariat already had discussions on blockchain solutions?

- OEKO-TEX® Secretariat, CF: Yes, we have been engaged in the UNECE blockchain project. The project is currently not actively running.

CITEVE, BC: If the European Commission decides on the digital product passport, how should the OEKO-TEX® Association follow that?

- HTTI, SD: We need to screen the development, also the developments in each country.

9. Technical Updates 2024 (RSL/MRSL)

In the following only the results are documented.

Substances to be updated

- VOCs in Annex 4 – Accepted
  - OEKO-TEX, JPH: The transition period should be only 1 year, and if issues come up it can be extended - Accepted
- Phenol - Accepted

SVHCs

- Glutaraldehyde – Accepted
- Diphenyl (2,4,6-trimethylbenzoyl)phosphine oxide - Accepted
- Bis(4-chlorophenyl) sulphone – Accepted
- 1,4-Dioxane - Accepted

PFAS

- Extractable organic fluorine vs total fluorine – Accepted
  - The control test will be charged – Accepted
- Method development for wastewater testing - Accepted

ECO PASSPORT

- Chemicals for foam production – Accepted
- Risks substances for ECO PASSPORT – Accepted

STANDARD 100

- Microencapsulated products – Not accepted. There will be no general ban. Further specification is required.

LEATHER STANDARD

- Leather origin – Accepted

10. Quality Management

10.1 Control Test

Main presentation: see slides 49 - 78

10.2 Control Test 22/23

The presented information was well perceived and no comments or questions were raised.

10.3 MADE IN GREEN

The presented information was well perceived and no comments or questions were raised.

10.4 Control Test 23/24

The presented information was well perceived

OEKO-TEX®, JPH: Sister certificates deliver no additional benefits. The Executive Meeting agreed to reduce the number of control testing by 50% of sister certificates last year. This year all sister certificates were excluded. If sister certificates are reduced in price, they will not be taken into consideration for the control testing number.

- ➔ OEKO-TEX® Secretariat, ER: If numbers seem to be wrong, reach out to ER for correction.

10.5 Round robin test

The presented information was well perceived.

HTTI, SD: Do we need the double testing?

- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, ER: The double testing has already been done, but the reporting is delayed.

IFTH, CR: Is it possible to receive the results of the round robin tests?

- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, ER: If there is delay and lack of reply, let us know.

OEKO-TEX®, JPH: It is difficult to find leather samples for testing. If FILK has material, it would be great to share it with the RRT Team.

10.6 Institute Audits

The presented information was well perceived and no comments or questions were raised.

11. On-Site-Visit/Audit Management

The presented information was well perceived and no comments or questions were raised.

11.1 Standard 100 & Leather Standard

The presented information was well perceived.

CENTROCOT, GC: What is the difference between self-reporting and intranet data?

- OEKO-TEX® Secretariat, ER: The self-reported information are request by ER from the institutes via email and the intranet data is what can be accessed from ER directly
- HTTI, SD: Recognized that colleagues take data also form intranet. The institutes should have a look in receiving more reliable data.
- TESTEX, JH: Intranet list is not correct due to the challenges described on the slide.

11.2 ECO PASSPORT

The presented information was well perceived and no comments or questions were raised.

12. OEKO-TEX® Success stories & Project updates

12.1 Business development overview

Main information: see presentation 88 - 107

The presented information was well perceived.

CENTROCOT, GC: Centrocot would like to be part of the Reycling Working Group – Accepted

FILK, HS: FILK is interested in taking part in the Working Group on shoes – Accepted

AITEX, VB: More information should be visible on the OEKO-TEX® STANDARD 100 certificate when recycled material is tested.

- OEKO-TEX® Secretariat, IB: Agrees from a marketing perspective, but IT development would be required. We can have a look at it.
- RISE, LÖ: Disagrees, OEKO-TEX® should not promote the recycling.
- OEKO-TEX®, IB: The topic should be taken back into the STANDARD 100 Working Group to discuss it from a technical perspective.

CENTROCOT, GC: Could the names of the spinners and ginners that already received an OEKO-TEX® ORGANIC COTTON certificate be shared with the institutes to push the institutes customers to work with those facilities?

- TESTEX, JH: The problem is that these data currently cannot be displayed in the Buying Guide, as IT development would be required. The data can be extracted manually. The OEKO-TEX® Secretariat will come back to GC.

MADE IN GREEN Roadmap

TESTEX, JH: We should have a tool to transport data not only upstream, but also downstream.

Responsible Business

CENTROCOT, GC: We have a customer, which is a finishing company, that is interested in receiving an OEKO-TEX® RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS certification. Producers are currently not part of the target group. Will there be developments in future?

- OEKO-TEX® Secretariat, MT: The RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS Working Group prepared a proposal on that. It will be discussed later.

12.2 MADE IN GREEN

The presented information was well perceived and no comments or questions were raised.

12.3 OEKO-TEX® RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS & STeP

In the following only the results are documented.

- Reduced Licence Fee – Accepted
- Scope and Applicability of RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS – Accepted

  CENTROCOT, GC: I do not agree to exclude commission dyeing

  - OEKO-TEX®, JH: problem: OEKO-TEX® RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS was created for the European market.

  DTI, JR: Would it be necessary for facilities to have also OEKO-TEX® Responsible Business?

  - OEKO-TEX®, JH: Not necessary

12.4 Marketing & Communication

Main information: see presentation 132 - 152

OEKO-TEX® Secretariat, IB: What do customers associate with OEKO-TEX® as a brand?

- ➔ General institutes perception: OEKO-TEX® STANDARRD 100 and OEKO-TEX® as a solution provider along the supply chain

OEKO-TEX® Secretariat, IB: What is the perception of the institutes on fairs?

- ➔ HTTI, SD: Different opinions on the topic. The feedback from ITMA was important and also to pitch besides bluesign. We should focus in the most important fairs but improve the leads.
- ➔ SHIRLEY, SD: We perceive a much higher attendance when inviting to seminars.
- ➔ INNOVATEXT, LP: An attractive performance and presentation of OEKO-TEX® is important.

CENTEXBEL, JL: ISEAL said that we could do better in communication. This might be important to position ourselves as solution provider.

- ➔ OEKO-TEX® Secretariat, IB: Agree, can always do better.

13. Stakeholder Engagement

Main information: see presentation slides 11 -17

The presented information was well perceived and no comments or questions were raised.

14. Digital Product Passport

14.1 General Input from Lisa

Main information: see presentation slides

14.2 Q&A with Lisa Schwarz Bour, Rise

OEKO-TEX®, JPH: What kind of technology is consider for the DPP?

Rise, LB: RFID tags are most likely to be consider, but it is not end-consumer friendly at the moment

OEKO-TEX®, JPH: How will the information be structured in the DPP?

Rise, LB: A lot of details are still under discussion at the commission, but it is clear that the information needs to be delivered in a structured ways.

OEKO-TEX®, JPH: Will the data be stored centralized or decentralised?

Rise, LB: This is not confirmed yet, but my assumption is that the solution will be a decentralized database

Hohenstein, SD: What is the exact timeframe for the DPP?

Rise, LB: The first product groups will be launched from 2025 on. It will be a step by step approach.

Rise, LB: The delegated act will be written by the commission. Rise choose the Cirpass project to be involved. LB recommends to stay as close as possible to the discussion and try to give input. Labelling and standard organisation are an important information for DPP.

OEKO-TEX(R9, JPH: What is the best initiative or project OEKO-TEX® should be participate in?

Rise, LB: Textile EPP, Cirpass, answer Stakeholder Consultation, Eurotex

Citeve, BC: Consult as well the nine initiatives that are presented in the presentation from Citeve

IFTH, CR: How can the verification of information for the DPP be done?

Rise, LB: It is up at discussion with the commission right now and there is no clear answer at the

moment.

Rise LB: I recommend to stay on top of mind with DPP there are lot of unknown circumstances

Discussion initiated by OEKO-TEX®:

1. Where do you see potential for OEKO-TEX?

- IFTH, CR: The Label Check is important to display the information and should be further developed.
- Hohenstein, SD: We need to have substantial resources to follow up and engage. We would need to evaluate additionally if the DPP can a business opportunity for OEKO-TEX®?
- Aitex, VB: Focus on information for end-consumers, display the RSL, analyse what stakeholders do, evaluate competitor, push recycling into OEKO-TEX®
- Citeve, BC: DPP will be reality. DPP is a threat for us, but can be develop into an opportunity. From BC point of view the commission will control the system. To invest into a solution might not be the best. Focus on validation and verification of the data that goes into the DPP. Where can OEKO-TEX® deliver service to validate DPP? The secretariat should work on a proposal.
- Centexbel, JL: We do not have to be the first mover – better late follower and make it right with more value for the customer.
- Centrocot, GC: We need to take the opportunity as brands need support with DPP.
- OEKO-TEX®, JPH: OEKO-TEX® needs to keep close contact of what is going on.

  Suggestion: Create a topic or task group to exchange knowledge.
- Hohenstein, SD: A Pilot with companies / start-ups who work with DPP. How can we put our data in the system to evaluate opportunities or not?
- Citeve, BC: Citeve is willing to support as Citive has a pilot project running.

Next Steps, that were agreed on

OEKO-TEX® secretariat (CF) gets in contact with Citeve, Rise, Hohenstein and Testex. A small group should monitor the development and communicate and inform about the newest developments.

15. Raw materials

15.1 General Input

Main information: see presentation slides 160 - 164

Due to time reasons, the OEKO-TEX® Secretariat will send a follow up, gather feedback, consolidate it and communicate it on the next General Manager meeting.

CENTROCOT, GC: Proposed to OEKO-TEX® Secretariat getting in contact with ORIGIAN

16. Traceability

Main information: see presentation slides

Due to time reasons the OEKO-TEX® Association will get back to the speakers with questions after the meeting.

17. Legal

Main information: see presentation slides 19 - 27

17.1 Upcoming legislation

The presented information was well perceived and no comments or questions were raised.

17.2 Transparency

The presented information was well perceived and no comments or questions were raised.

17.3 Data protection

The presented information was well perceived.

FILK, HS: The legal input shows the relevance of accreditation. What is the status quo for OEKO-TEX® on that topic?

- OEKO-TEX® Secretariat, CB: It is an important part, but came to conclusion that if we would have standards be evaluated, standards would be open to other accreditation bodies, no option for the OEKO-TEX® community, did risk analysis and do preventive measures.
- CENTEXBEL, JL: We should follow the risk analysis to mitigate risks.
- OEKO-TEX® Secretariat, CB: A risk analysis was concluded and the definition of preventive measures. For the institutes there are currently no steps to be taken. The OEKO-TEX® Secretariat will follow the legal developments.
- HTTI, SD: We should request the help of ISEAL to receive input on the independence topic.

18. Institute`s Expectations of OEKO-TEX® Secretariat Zurich

HTTI, SM: Thanks especially JPH for taking over responsibility and thanks INNVOATEXT as well as the OEKO-TEX® Secretariat for the organisation of the meeting.

19. Various

- The next General Manager meeting will be held on the 24-25th October 2024 in Alcoy, Spain at the new Aitex Headquater.
- JPH reminds the OEKO-TEX® Association on the fair play rules
- Thank you for the successful meeting.

The meeting was closed, 27th October 4:20 pm